

# FILM DOSSIER: DOCTOR STRANGE

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Phase 3 · Film #3 (Saga Film #20)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 20 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #3)                                                            |
| Phase                  | Phase 3                                                                                |
| Real title             | <i>DOCTOR STRANGE</i>                                                                  |
| Decoy / codename title | <i>"HOUSE CALL"</i>                                                                    |
| Release date           | Friday, November 4, 2016                                                               |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                                    |
| Director               | Scott Derrickson                                                                       |
| Rating / runtime       | PG-13 · 150 minutes                                                                    |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>occult horror-fantasy</b> / <b>psychedelic mystery</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>BENEDICT CUMBERBATCH</b> , the most iconic real Doctor Strange (Casting Rule 3).<br>The Doctor Strange franchise is his. |

| Character                                                                       | Actor                              | Age at release |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Dr. Stephen Strange</b>                                                      | Benedict Cumberbatch               | 40             |
| <b>Baron Karl Mordo</b>                                                         | Chiwetel Ejiofor                   | 39             |
| <b>Wong</b>                                                                     | Benedict Wong                      | 45             |
| <b>The Ancient One</b>                                                          | Tilda Swinton (🚧 see casting note) | 55             |
| <b>Clea</b>                                                                     | Charlize Theron                    | 41             |
| <b>Dormammu</b> (voice and on-set performance capture)                          | Benedict Cumberbatch               | 40             |
| <b>The Silver Surfer</b> (post-credit)                                          | Doug Jones / Laurence Fishburne    | 56 / 55        |
| <b>Mephisto</b> (post-credit)                                                   | Ciarán Hinds                       | 63             |
| <b>Stan Lee</b> (cameo: a man on a bus reading <i>Aldous Huxley</i> , laughing) | Stan Lee                           | 93             |

🚧 Casting note: on 616, the Ancient One is an elderly Tibetan man. Tilda Swinton is the only real actor to have played the role, so the Casting Rules give it to her. Everything else about the character (history, powers, wisdom, and death) is 100% 616. ✅ Locked by the showrunner: Swinton keeps the role.\*\*

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                           | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Primary comic(s) adapted</b> | <b><i>Strange Tales</i> #115</b> (December 1963), Stan Lee & Steve Ditko: " <b>The Origin of Dr. Strange.</b> " <b><i>Strange Tales</i> #126–127</b> (1964): <b>Dormammu</b> and the <b>Dark Dimension</b> , and <b>Clea</b> .                                                                      |
| <b>Supporting comics</b>        | <i>Strange Tales</i> #110 (1963, first appearance) · <i>Strange Tales</i> #111 (1963, <b>Baron Mordo</b> , a villain from the start) · <i>Strange Tales</i> #130–146 (1965–66, Ditko's <b>Eternity</b> saga) · <i>Doctor Strange</i> #1 (1974, <b>the Sanctum Sanctorum</b> , 177A Bleecker Street) |
| <b>Nerf check</b>               | ✅ <b>Dormammu is far more powerful than Strange.</b> Strange wins <b>by out-thinking him with a Sorcerer's bargain</b> , exactly as in <i>Strange Tales</i> #127. Dormammu <b>honors the deal</b> because he's <b>bound by his word</b> , and he isn't weakened.                                    |

### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                         |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | 95%. The Ditko origin and the first Dormammu story are adapted closely. The Ancient One's casting is flagged. |

#### Straight from the page:

- **Dr. Stephen Strange** is a **brilliant, arrogant neurosurgeon**. A **car crash** wrecks the nerves in his hands (#115).
- He spends his fortune on cures that fail, and travels to the **Himalayas** to find **the Ancient One** (#115).
- **Baron Mordo**, the Ancient One's student, **is secretly trying to kill his master**. Strange finds out, and Mordo **puts a spell on him to keep him quiet** (#115). (*Mordo is a villain from the start, as on 616.*)
- Strange **gives up his selfishness** and becomes the Ancient One's student to protect him (#115).
- **The Cloak of Levitation, the Eye of Agamotto, the Sanctum Sanctorum, 177A Bleecker Street, Wong**.
- **Dormammu**, lord of the **Dark Dimension**, attacks. **Clea**, Dormammu's niece, helps Strange (#126).
- **Strange beats Dormammu**, not by force but by getting him to **swear** to leave Earth alone (#127).

#### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Ancient One is played by Tilda Swinton | The Casting Rules, confirmed by the showrunner. |

| The Eye of Agamotto is a **wisdom and truth-revealing** amulet (616), **not** an Infinity Gem | 616 accurate. The MCU's Gems are the six Thanos holds. |

#### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character              | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Shown in this film                                                                                                   | Held back (why)                                                           | Match     |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Doctor Strange</b>  | <b>Master of the mystic arts:</b> spells, shields, <b>astral projection</b> , dimensional portals, invoking the Vishanti; <b>the Cloak of Levitation</b> (flight); <b>the Eye of Agamotto</b> (truth, seeing through illusions); a genius mind ( <i>ST #110</i> on) | All of it: the Shields of Seraphim, the Crimson Bands of Cyttorak, astral projection, fighting in the Dark Dimension | <b>Sorcerer Supreme</b> (616: conferred later, when the Ancient One dies) | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Dormammu</b>        | <b>Master of the Dark Dimension:</b> vast mystic power, flame-headed, near-omnipotent in his own realm ( <i>ST #126</i> )                                                                                                                                           | Dwarfs Strange in every exchange                                                                                     | –                                                                         | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>The Ancient One</b> | The Sorcerer Supreme, enormous mystic power                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Throws Strange's astral form out of his body; holds off Mordo effortlessly                                           | –                                                                         | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Baron Mordo</b>     | Powerful sorcerer; astral projection                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Duels Strange in the astral plane                                                                                    | –                                                                         | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Clea</b>            | Faltine sorceress, Dormammu's niece                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Frees Strange in the Dark Dimension                                                                                  | –                                                                         | ✓<br>100% |

## 4. STORY

| Field                       | Entry                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Logline</b>              | A genius surgeon loses his hands and his future, and finds the other side of reality instead, where the thing waiting for him is hungrier than any god. |
| <b>Theme</b>                | <b>Ego and surrender.</b> Stephen thinks he can fix everything. Magic teaches him that the world doesn't revolve around him.                            |
| <b>Villain / antagonist</b> | <b>Dormammu</b> (main); <b>Baron Mordo</b>                                                                                                              |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: THE CRASH

- **Monday, November 9, 2015. Dr. Stephen Strange**, the best neurosurgeon in New York, crashes his Lamborghini on a mountain road. **His hands are ruined.**
- Every surgery fails. His money runs out.
- He goes to the Himalayas to find a legend: **the Ancient One.**

## ACT TWO: KAMAR-TAJ

- **The Ancient One** and **Wong** take him in. Stephen doesn't believe in magic until he's **thrown out of his own body**.
- He learns the mystic arts: the **Cloak of Levitation**, the **Eye of Agamotto**, the astral plane.
- He finds out that **Baron Mordo**, the Ancient One's top student, is **trying to kill him**.
- Mordo **binds Strange with a spell** so he can't warn anyone.
- Strange chooses **to stay and protect his master** anyway. **That's the moment he becomes a hero.**

## ACT THREE: THE DARK DIMENSION

- Mordo turns to **Dormammu**, lord of the **Dark Dimension**, for power.
  - Dormammu attacks Earth through the **Sanctum Sanctorum** on **Bleecker Street**.
  - Strange goes **into the Dark Dimension**. A young sorceress, **Clea**, Dormammu's niece, secretly helps him.
  - Strange and Dormammu: a hopeless fight. Strange **tricks Dormammu into swearing** by his own power never to harm Earth again.
  - Dormammu is **bound by his oath** and leaves, raging.
  - Strange comes home to the Sanctum with Wong. He looks at his scarred, trembling hands, which are strong enough now to hold the world together.
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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>Monday, November 9, 2015</b> (the crash) → <b>Saturday, October 15, 2016</b> (Dormammu). The post-credit scene takes place <b>the same week</b> .                                                               |
| Where it's set          | <b>New York City</b> (Metro-General Hospital, <b>the Sanctum Sanctorum, 177A Bleecker Street</b> ) · <b>Kamar-Taj, in the Himalayas</b> (filmed in Nepal) · <b>the Dark Dimension</b> (practical psychedelic sets) |
| Relative to other films | <b>It runs through <i>Civil War</i>, <i>Black Panther</i>, and <i>Silver Surfer's</i> exile.</b> Strange ignores Civil War completely: <i>"I have bigger problems."</i>                                            |

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## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **The mystic arts, Kamar-Taj, the Sanctum, Dormammu, the Dark Dimension.**
- **Strange, Wong, Clea, and Mordo** (now his enemy).

## World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                | How it appears                                 | Payoff                       |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Magic defends Earth | The Sanctum is a ward against other dimensions | <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> |
| The Surfer          | The post-credit scene                          | <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> |
| Mordo lives         | He escapes                                     | A Doctor Strange sequel      |

## Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed                  | How it appears                                                                              | What it means                                          |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| The Eye sees the snap | Strange looks through the Eye of Agamotto and sees <b>half of all life fading at once</b> . | Earth's <b>Sorcerer-in-waiting</b> knows what's coming |
| Mephisto, recognized  | The post-credit scene                                                                       | Strange knows who's whispering in Thanos's ear         |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | ✅ "SANCTUM." Wong hands Strange a stack of library fines from Kamar-Taj. Strange: " <i>I was saving the universe.</i> " Wong: " <i>The library doesn't care.</i> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Post-credit scene      | ✅ "THE WARNING." The <b>Silver Surfer</b> lands in the Sanctum's courtyard. <b>Strange</b> is waiting.<br><b>SURFER:</b> " <i>You feel it too.</i> "<br><b>STRANGE:</b> " <i>I've seen it. The Titan, and the one whispering to him.</i> " He turns the Eye toward the stars, and in its light <b>Mephisto's face</b> smiles back at them.<br><b>STRANGE:</b> " <i>Mephisto.</i> "<br><b>SURFER (going pale):</b> " <i>Then we have very little time.</i> " <b>CUT TO BLACK. "DOCTOR STRANGE WILL RETURN."</b> |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: " <b>OVERDUE.</b> " Post-credit: " <b>HOUSEGUEST.</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building

· [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline